

▽ The Martyrdom of Thomas Becket, alabaster relief



1170

## 1175 MUHAMMAD OF GHUR INVADES INDIA

The Sultan of the Ghurid empire (in present-day Afghanistan) invaded northern India and later pushed into the Punjab, creating a Muslim empire. After a battle at Tarain in 1192, he captured Delhi, where his military slave and Governor of Delhi, Qutb-ud-Din Aybak, began the Qutb Minar to commemorate his victory. Struggles with the Khwarezmians in Iran slowed further conquest and after Muhammad's death in 1206, the empire fell apart.

▷ Qutb Minar, Delhi, India



1170

## MURDER OF THOMAS BECKET

The Archbishop of Canterbury, Thomas Becket, was murdered inside his own cathedral by knights who believed they were carrying out the orders of the English king, Henry II. Becket had argued with the king over the monarch's attempts to extend royal control over the Church, and had his former friend and master excommunicated. The king's order to kill Beckett may have been the result of a miscommunication.

**1175 The Pure Land sect of Buddhism** is established in Japan

**1171 Henry II of England** lands in Ireland to assert English overlordship

## 1176 DEFEAT OF FREDERICK BARBAROSSA

The Holy Roman Emperor Frederick Barbarossa was defeated at the Battle of Legnano by the Lombard League, an alliance of restive cities in northern Italy. Frederick had invaded Italy four times in the previous two decades trying to impose imperial control over the cities; this fifth expedition ended in disaster as the League's infantry stubbornly fought off imperial cavalry attacks. Frederick retreated to Germany and in 1183 was forced to recognize the autonomy of the League cities.



△ The Battle of Legnano